

British revolution

The Industrial Revolution began in Great Britain. Later, it spread to Europe, the United States, and across the world.



Iron bridge

The world's first cast-iron bridge opened in 1781. The impressive structure crosses the River Severn in Shropshire, in an industrial area now known as Ironbridge.



First steam engine



First moving steam engine



SS Great Western

In 1712, Thomas Newcomen built the first steam engine. It pumped water out of mines.

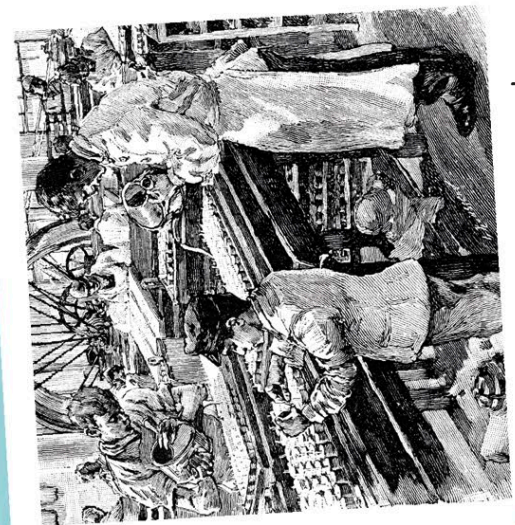
Richard Trevithick built the first moving steam engine in 1804.

Isambard Kingdom Brunel launched this huge new steam-powered ship in Bristol in 1837. It was designed to get to the United States very fast.

People called Luddites attacked the machines that now did their jobs between 1811 and 1813.

Child labor

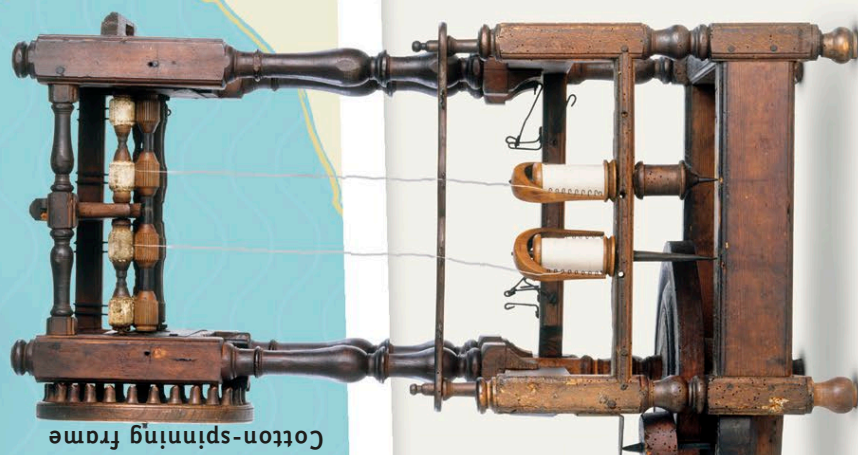
Children as young as four worked in the new factories and coal mines. Their work was often dangerous, and many were killed. Laws were passed from the 1830s onward to limit the hours and ages at which children were allowed to work.



A child textile-factory worker

New inventions

There were many new inventions in the Industrial Revolution. New machines and high-powered steam engines made it faster to create products, such as cotton and wool cloth, iron tools, machines, and pottery.



Cotton-spinning frame